STU PENDER

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Product designer building tools to support embodied presence. I design the interface, then ship it myself.

SUMMARY

Product designer with UX/UI training and shipped client and personal work. I take expert domains — music theory, audio archives, a thirty-year teaching practice — and design calm, legible interfaces for them: research and flows, visual systems, and the production front-end in React, TypeScript and Electron, built with AI-assisted development (Claude Code). I've worked with a PM, a WordPress developer and clients directly; fifteen years of teaching is how I learned to make hard things simple.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Product Designer & Front-End Developer — 2015 – Present

Freelance and client work · Chicago / remote

- **Vox Mundi School — Yoga of the Voice (2026).** Designed and built the landing page for a 108-hour Certificate, keeping the client's AI-drafted structure and refining its voice. Live in about 48 hours; the first review came back with three small edits, and it's now the school's front door for the programme.
- That page opened an ongoing ~15-page site consolidation for the school, including the content architecture handed to its WordPress developer.
- **Joan Gutiérrez (2026).** Brand and marketing site for an embodiment educator — palette, type, a "four ways in" structure, and a low-pressure discovery call as the main action; designed and built end to end.
- **Jon Adams — The Ground Beneath Our Feet (2018).** Personas, flows, wireframes, brand identity, hi-fi mockups and the shipped front-end for a music-licensing catalog.
- **Seed Worldwide.** Brand landing page for a digital music distribution company, still live.

Product Designer — Expressionist (early-stage startup concept) — 2018 – 2020

- Led product design with the team's PM: user flows, lo-fi screens, and a clickable Figma prototype. The work reached investor interest.

Senior Instructor & Curriculum Developer — Private Studio / Tunelark — 2011 – Present

- Teach students of all ages online and in person; write curriculum that turns complex material into clear, learnable steps. Designed and built Fretboard Constellations to teach from.

Producer & Project Manager — Independent / Client Work — 2015 – Present

- Music and sonic-branding work for recurring clients, including podcasts and independent artists — scoping, scheduling and delivery on deadline, as the sole point of contact across creative, technical and admin needs.

Records Intern — !K7 Records — 2015

Brooklyn, NY

- Led an archival digitization project across a studio tape archive, organizing findings in structured spreadsheets and a shared folder system; compiled release charting data.

SELECTED PRODUCTS

Fretboard Constellations — interactive guitar-theory instrument

2025 – Present

Designer & developer · TypeScript, React, Web Audio, VexFlow · beingsound.studio/fretboard-constellations

- Designed for an expert teaching live on a shared screen: a calm Lesson Mode and a full Studio Mode, with nothing locked behind skill level.
- Built on a theory-as-data engine — new scales, chords and tunings are data files, not code. Deployed and in use.

Becoming — local-first app for life development

2026 – Present

Designer & developer · TypeScript, React, SQLite, Electron · stupender.github.io/becoming.html

- Time, energy and money in one place, designed to report, never grade: counts and shares, never scores or streaks — enforced at the API, so no screen can render one.
- Runs on a Mac and as a Home Screen app on iPad, with the same server code running inside the page, so the data never leaves the device. Imports bank statements locally, reconciled to the penny.

Archive — local-first macOS audio tool

2025 – Present

Designer & developer · TypeScript, Electron, Web Audio · github.com/stupender/archive

- An app for re-discovering a large music library: random review, A–B looping at variable speed, five-track layering with saved scenes, and smart playlists. Every control tested against one question — does it pull you out of the music?
- Shipped v0.1.0 as a tagged release with an installable .dmg and architecture docs; rebuilt time-stretching from pre-rendered to real-time after questioning the first design.

Being Sound — studio website

2025 – Present

Designer & developer · beingsound.studio

- Multi-page studio site with an embedded music player and an interactive tools page.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Design & research Interaction and visual design, brand identity, design tokens and systems, wireframing and prototyping, user research and surveys, personas, user stories and flows, competitive analysis, usability testing

Build HTML, CSS, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Electron, Vite, Web Audio API, Git/GitHub, WordPress, AI-assisted development (Claude Code)

Tools Figma, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite, Ableton Live, Logic Pro

EDUCATION & TRAINING

UX/UI Design & Front-End Development Mentorship — Bloc 2017 – 2018

Bachelor of Music, Jazz Studies (Cum Laude, GPA 3.78) — SUNY Purchase Conservatory of Music 2011 – 2015